

Kondwani Austin Phanga

Software Engineer • Backend & Infrastructure • Applied AI Systems

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Professional Summary

Software engineer and systems builder with 10+ years of experience across telecom infrastructure, secure operations, fintech systems, and applied AI. I design and deliver resilient backend systems, infrastructure workflows, and data-heavy applications that must function in real-world, high-accountability environments.

I bring a practical engineering mindset shaped by work in critical telecom operations, donor-funded digital delivery, edge AI, and distributed application design. I enjoy building systems that combine backend reliability, operational resilience, and clear user value - especially where production constraints, data integrity, and trust matter.

Core Skills

- - Backend engineering and API design
- - Python, FastAPI, Node.js, TypeScript, JavaScript
- - PostgreSQL, Redis, SQLite, SQL modeling
- - Async processing, queues, orchestration, and workflow design
- - Cloud and infrastructure awareness
- - Docker, Kubernetes-oriented deployment patterns
- - Security-conscious system design and operational resilience
- - Observability, incident-response thinking, and reliability engineering
- - Edge AI, local-first systems, and privacy-preserving workflows
- - Mobile and embedded/infrastructure tooling
- - Cross-functional delivery and stakeholder communication

Professional Experience

Managing Director & Studio Manager | 7arts Creative Agency | Lilongwe, Malawi | 2023 - Present

- - Lead a digital production agency serving enterprise, donor, and public-sector clients across technical delivery, operational continuity, and stakeholder management.
- - Manage multi-project workstreams, production schedules, infrastructure continuity, and client-facing execution in a fast-moving environment.
- - Maintain internal systems, backups, and operational governance supporting a high-visibility agency environment.
- - Contribute to business development, delivery planning, and technical execution for institutional and private-sector engagements.

Founder & Creative Director | Phanga Studio / Phanga Media | Lilongwe, Malawi | 2017 - 2022

- - Founded and led a media and communications studio delivering campaigns, documentary work, and institutional storytelling projects.
- - Built custom production workflows, digital systems, and web infrastructure to support field production, client delivery, and project operations.

- - Developed applied technology prototypes and internal tools that informed later work in edge intelligence, automation, and product systems.

IT Officer - Enterprise Data Centre Operations | Malawi Telecommunications Limited (MTL) | Blantyre & Lilongwe, Malawi | 2010 - 2013

- - Managed enterprise telecom infrastructure including server racks, SAN/NAS storage, LAN/WAN systems, and production operations.
- - Configured security controls, perimeter protections, and access policies to support service reliability and operational integrity.
- - Supported backup validation, disaster recovery procedures, and failover readiness in a production environment with critical uptime requirements.

Selected Project Work

Solar Edge Fleet Data Platform

- - Designed a distributed edge-computing platform for field devices with local buffering, telemetry capture, and opportunistic synchronization.
- - Built using FastAPI, Celery, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, and Kubernetes-oriented service patterns.
- - Focused on resilience under intermittent connectivity and constrained operations.

AMR - Mobile Money Reconciliation SaaS

- - Built a multi-tenant reconciliation platform for settlement and disbursement workflows across mobile money systems.
- - Designed validation logic, workflow controls, and operational guardrails for high-integrity financial processes.

Tilemera - MSE Listing Readiness Diagnostic SaaS

- - Developed a B2B compliance-readiness platform for SMEs preparing for listing on the Malawi Stock Exchange.
- - Built a monorepo architecture using Fastify, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Redis, and BullMQ for asynchronous processing and document readiness flows.

RouterPass - Local Network Sidecar & AI Troubleshooting System

- - Built a Python-based system connecting to MikroTik RouterOS APIs and indexing local network state for troubleshooting workflows.
- - Integrated local model execution with Ollama to support secure, private troubleshooting without cloud dependence.

Zisamale - Clinical Intelligence Platform & Offline Sync

- - Built a clinical data platform pairing Android clients using SQLite WAL transactions with an asynchronous FastAPI and RabbitMQ backend.
- - Designed offline-first sync and data validation flows for health data sovereignty and operational continuity.

Education

BSc in Computer Engineering | University of Livingstonia | Malawi | 2013 - 2017

- - Software Engineering, Distributed Systems, Database Management, Network Security

International Diploma in Computing | NACIT | Blantyre, Malawi | 2010 - 2011

- - Systems Administration, Enterprise Infrastructure, LAN/WAN Networking, Technical Support

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (Candidate) | Amazon Web Services | 2026

- - Focus on secure architecture, VPC principles, resilience, and cloud service design

Additional Information

- - Open to remote, hybrid, and international work
- - Interested in backend engineering, platform engineering, infrastructure engineering, and applied AI roles
- - Strong alignment with organizations building reliable, secure, and production-focused software systems

Short Professional Profile

Computer engineer and systems builder with 10+ years across telecom infrastructure, fintech workflows, digital operations, and applied AI. Delivers resilient backend systems, operational clarity, and technically grounded solutions in complex environments.